

Geographical Indications in India



Source: PIB

Why in News?

Geographical Indication (GI) tags are increasingly protecting India's cultural heritage by linking distinctive products to their places of origin, preventing misuse and improving market recognition for artisans, farmers, weavers and producer groups.

- Supported by **legal protection and government initiatives in finance, exports, tourism and marketing**, India's expanding GI ecosystem is strengthening rural livelihoods, consumer trust and the global visibility of traditional products.

What is the Geographical Indication (GI)?

- **About:** A geographical indication (GI) is a designation applied to products originating from a specific geographical area, indicating that the qualities or reputation of the products are inherently linked to that particular origin.
- **Definition:** Article 22 (1) of **Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS)** defines **GIs as "indications which identify a good as originating in the territory of a member, or a region or locality in that territory, where a given quality, reputation or other characteristic of the good is essentially attributable to its geographic origin"**.
- **International Legal Framework:** Geographical Indications (GIs) are recognised under the **Paris Convention for the Protection of Industrial Property** and the **World Trade Organization's Agreement on Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights**.

Indian Geographical Indication (GI) Framework

- **Legal Framework:** GIs are governed by the **Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999**, and the **Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Rules, 2002**.
- **Administration:** The Geographical Indications Registry administers GI registration and protection in India. GI registration is **valid for ten years and may be renewed for successive ten-year periods**.
- **Cancellation:** Under **Section 27**, registration may be cancelled, varied or rectified if **improperly obtained, misleading, generic or legally non-compliant**.
- **Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) (Amendment) Rules, 2025:** The **2025 amendment** reduced GI application and related fees by 80% and lowered the renewal fee

from ₹3,000 to ₹500 .

- **Registration Growth:** India has over **800 registered GI products** , including 607 granted since 2014; authorised users rose from 365 to around 29,000 by January 2025.
- **Leading States:** As of December 2025, **Uttar Pradesh led with 81 GI-tagged** products, followed by Tamil Nadu with 76 and Maharashtra with 55.
- **First Registrations:** **Darjeeling Tea** was India's first registered GI, followed by early products such as **Aranmula Kannadi** and **Pochampally Ikat** .



Significance

- **Heritage and Authenticity:** GI tags preserve traditional knowledge and indigenous craftsmanship while assuring consumers of a product's origin, quality and cultural value.
- **Livelihood and Income Gains:** Greater visibility, bargaining power and access to premium markets can raise artisans' incomes by 20–30% and **create sustainable livelihoods for local producers.**
- **Export Promotion:** GI recognition improves **global market access**, as seen in the export of 30 metric tonnes of Muzaffarnagar jaggery to Bangladesh in 2025, benefiting 545 farmer-members.



How is the Government Strengthening India's GI Ecosystem?

- **PM Ekta Malls:** **PM Ekta Malls** provide dedicated retail spaces for GI-tagged products , **One District One Product** items and handicrafts. The government allocated ₹5,000 crore for establishing these malls across States.
- **One Station One Product:** **Dedicated railway stalls enable artisans, farmers, weavers and producer** groups to directly market regional crafts, textiles and food products to passengers.
- **GI-Based Tourism :** GI clusters are being integrated into tourism through initiatives such as weaving-village and tea-estate trails. **Assam's proposed Muga Silk Trail, Silk Tourism Park and Muga Utsav** seek to promote silk heritage tourism.
- **MSME Innovative Scheme:** Its **Intellectual Property Rights component reimburses up to 100% of GI-registration expenses** , subject to a maximum of ₹2 lakh for each registered GI.
- **Legal and Financial Assistance:** The **Development Commissioner for Handicrafts provides up to ₹1.5 lakh for GI enforcement** and related legal expenses. Assistance is also provided for registration, institutional training and effective enforcement.
- **Handloom Promotion:** As of **June 2026, 104 GI-registered handloom products** and 53 registrations were supported under Handloom Marketing Assistance, a component of the National Handloom Development Programme.
- **APEDA's Export Support:** **APEDA** promotes GI-tagged agricultural products through **quality improvement, capacity building, infrastructure development and overseas market promotion**.
 - **New Export Markets:** Karnataka's GI fruits reached the Maldives, Salem Sago entered Canada, Joha Rice reached the UK and Italy and Tezpur Litchi was exported to Dubai, improving farmers' returns and price realisation.
- **Trade Agreements:** GI protection is increasingly included in India's trade negotiations. **Indi Lime was exported to Oman after the India-Oman CEPA** , **New Zealand committed to facilitating registration of Indian GIs and India** and the **European Union** continued negotiations on a dedicated GI agreement.
- **Promotional Events:** GI goods are showcased through craft fairs, **Dilli Haat exhibitions**, seminars and events such as **GI & Beyond: Virasat se Vikas Tak** , **World Food India** and the **Tribal Business Conclave** .

Conclusion

GI tags are more than intellectual property certificates; they are instruments of **cultural preservation, rural development and export-led growth**. By protecting authenticity and linking products to their place of origin, GI tags can help artisans, weavers and farmers move from anonymous production to premium branding. With stronger authorised user registration, quality control, digital marketing, tourism integration and export promotion, India can scale its traditional wealth into globally recognised brands and strengthen the heritage economy.

Drishti Mains Question

Geographical Indication tags can transform India's traditional products into instruments of cultural preservation and rural economic growth. Discuss.

Frequently Asked Questions

1. What is a GI tag?

A GI tag is an intellectual property tag given to products whose quality, reputation or uniqueness is linked to a specific geographical origin.

2. Which was India's first GI-tagged product?

Darjeeling Tea from West Bengal was India's first GI-tagged product.

3. Which law governs GI tags in India?

GI tags in India are governed by the Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999.

4. How long is a GI registration valid?

A GI registration is valid for 10 years and can be renewed.

5. How do GI tags help artisans and farmers?

They help producers gain authenticity, better market recognition, premium pricing and protection from imitation.

6. What is an authorised user of a GI product?

An authorised user is a producer or entity legally permitted to use a registered GI for a product that meets the prescribed standards.

[Watch Video on YouTube: ▶ <https://www.youtube.com/embed/7Q4Nkc3auKg>]

UPSC Civil Services Examination Previous Year Question

Prelims

Q. Which of the following has/have been accorded 'Geographical Indication' status? (2015)

1. Banaras Brocades and Sarees
2. Rajasthani Daal-Bati-Churma
3. Tirupathi Laddu

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans: (c)

Q. India enacted the Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999 in order to comply with the obligations to (2018)

- (a) ILO
- (b) IMF
- (c) UNCTAD
- (d) WTO

Ans: (d)

Mains

Q. Safeguarding the Indian art heritage is the need of the moment. Discuss. (2018)

India's 1st Telecom Manufacturing Zone in Gwalior



Source:PIB

Telecom Manufacturing Zone (TMZ) in **Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh** secured **fresh investment commitments of Rs 2,000 crore** , taking the **total committed investment to Rs 5,500 crore** .

- **About:** The **Telecom Manufacturing Zone (TMZ)** in **Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh** is **India's first dedicated telecom manufacturing cluster** , designed to establish a **globally competitive, end-to-end telecom manufacturing ecosystem** .
- **Objective:** It aims to transform India from a **telecom services-led economy to a telecom products and manufacturing hub** under the vision of "**Make in India, Make for the World**" by increasing **domestic value addition** , creating **indigenous intellectual property (IP)** , and boosting **telecom exports** .
- **Integrated Ecosystem:** The TMZ will house the complete telecom value chain, including **design, research & development (R&D), testing, manufacturing, semiconductors, optical fibre, telecom equipment, electronic components, and allied industries** , supported by **common plug-and-play testing infrastructure** .
- **Employment:** The Zone is expected to generate **more than 18,000 employment opportunities** .
- **Strategic Advantages:** **Gwalior** offers a **central location, strong connectivity, skilled workforce, competitive operating costs, industrial ecosystem, and improved logistics** , including the upcoming **Agra-Gwalior Greenfield Expressway** .
- **Implementation:** The project will be jointly implemented through a **Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV)** comprising the **Department of Telecommunications (DoT)** and the **Government of Madhya Pradesh** , supported by **land, capital, skill development, employment-linked incentives, and logistics support** from the State Government.

Read more: [The Indian Telecom Revolution](#)